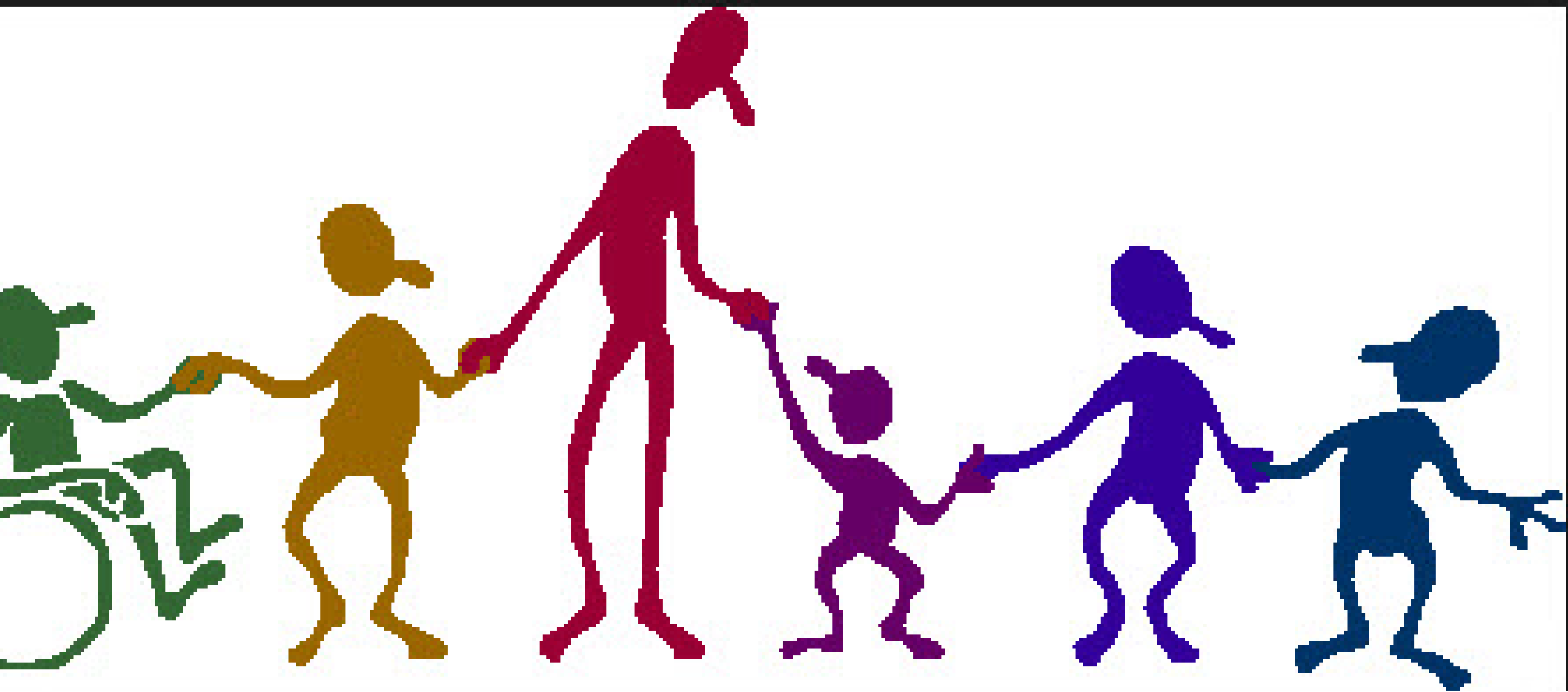




Supporting Students with Diverse Needs

Anjala Banzinger, District School Psychologist

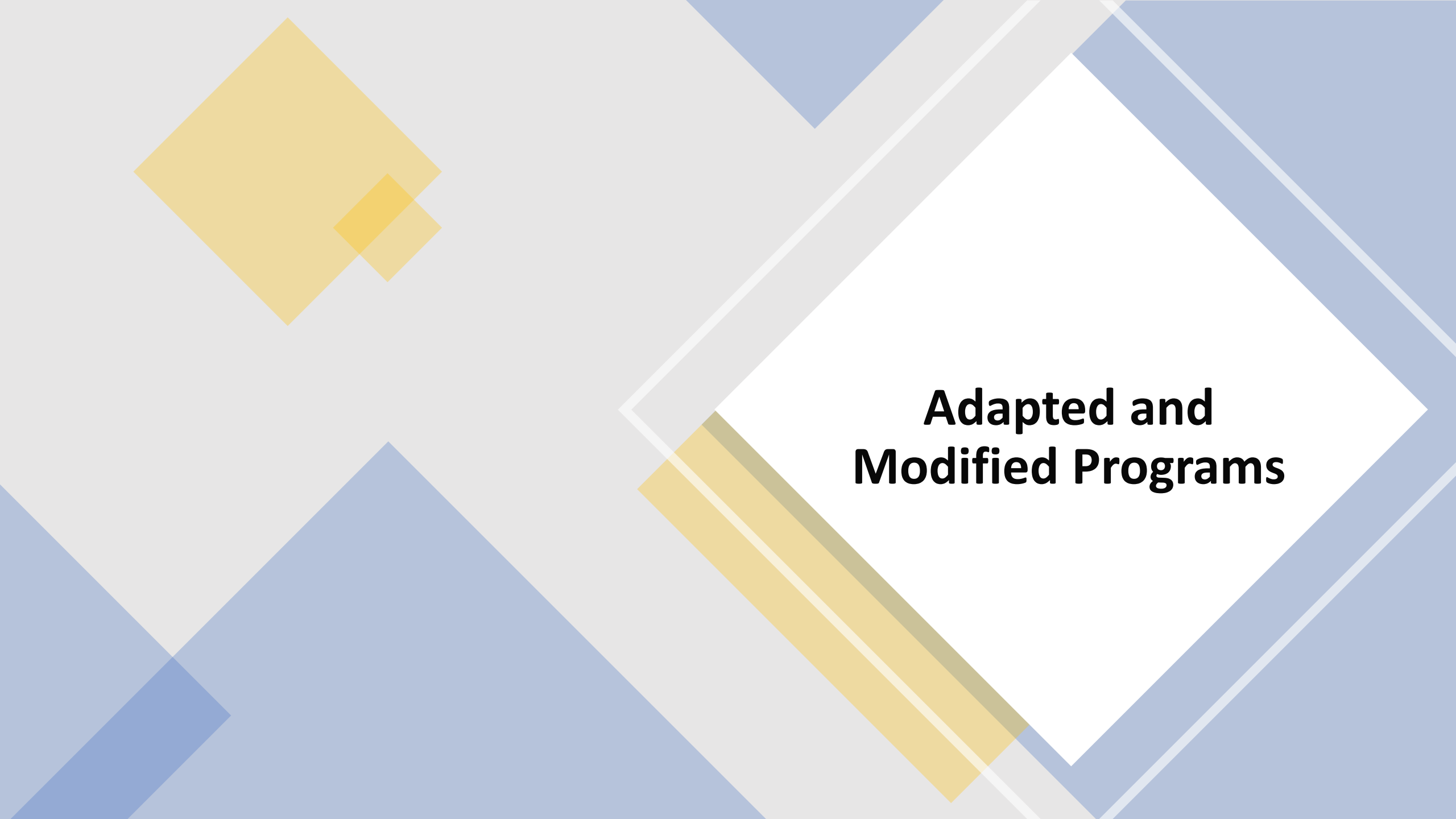
Day 1: Overview

Morning

- House Keeping
- Review Course Syllabus & Assignments
- Adapted v. Modified Programs
- Transition Planning
- Designation v. Diagnosis: Review

Afternoon

- Low Incidence Categories
- Categories A-D:
 - Overview, support considerations, and educational programming
 - Videos & Discussions



Adapted and Modified Programs



The Ministry of Education, ***Special Education Services: A Manual of Policies, Procedures and Guidelines*** describes adaptations as:

“teaching and assessment strategies especially designed to accommodate a student’s needs so he or she can achieve the learning outcomes/ standards of the subject or course and to demonstrate proficiency of concepts.”



Adapted Educational Programs



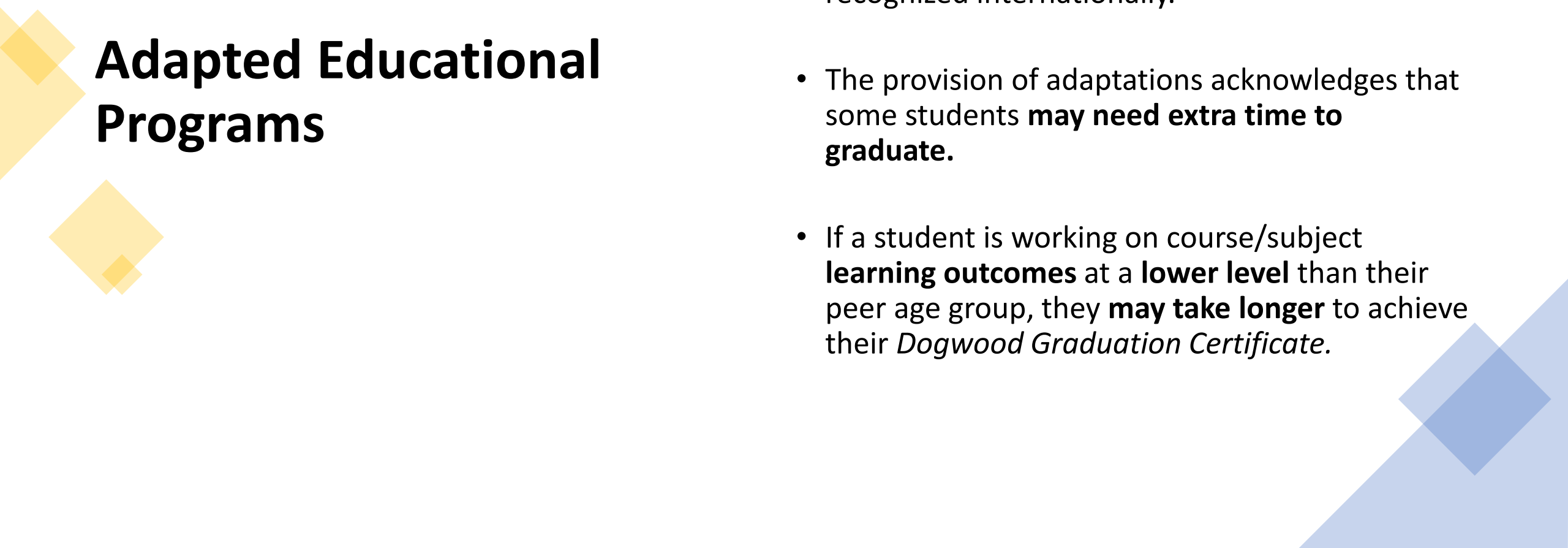
Adapted Educational Programs

- A student working on learning outcomes **at any grade or course level** may be supported through the use of adaptations.
- Adaptations may include alternate formats for resources, instructional strategies and/or assessment procedures.
- Some **examples of adaptations** include:
 - Different formats for resources to enable students to receive information, such as Braille and/or text-to-speech apps;
 - Different teaching strategies such as visual cues and/or breaking tasks into smaller parts;
 - Different ways of demonstrating learning such as oral exams, visual representation and/or extra time.



Adapted Educational Programs

- It is possible for a student to work on learning standards **from a different grade level** than their peer age class. When this is the case, the student will be:
 - Assessed and will **receive credit** for the **grade level course/subject** they are **working on**;
 - And the report card will reflect their success **at that grade/level**.
- 

The slide features decorative geometric shapes in the corners. On the left, there are several overlapping yellow squares and diamonds of various sizes. On the bottom right, there are overlapping blue squares and diamonds. The main content is centered on a white background.

Adapted Educational Programs

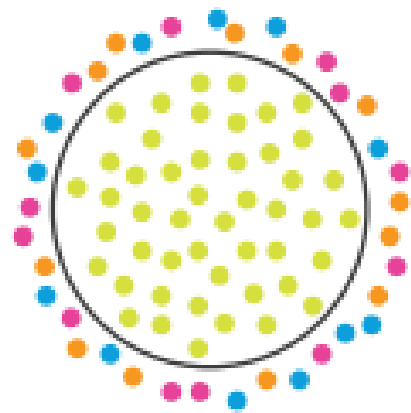
- Students receiving adaptations are working towards the same ***Dogwood Graduation Certificate*** as their peers. A *Dogwood Graduation Certificate* recognized the successful completion of the BC curriculum and is recognized internationally.
- The provision of adaptations acknowledges that some students **may need extra time to graduate.**
- If a student is working on course/subject **learning outcomes** at a **lower level** than their peer age group, they **may take longer** to achieve their *Dogwood Graduation Certificate*.

Adapted Educational Programs

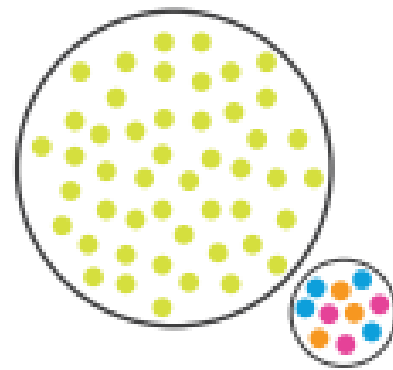
Shelley Moore: Inclusion 2.0

ACTIVITY:

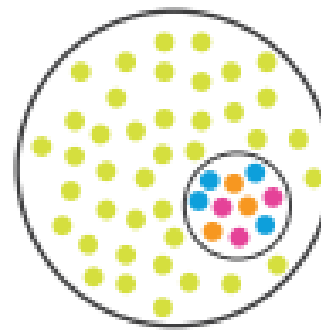
- With partners, discuss what you thought of this video.
- Large group sharing.



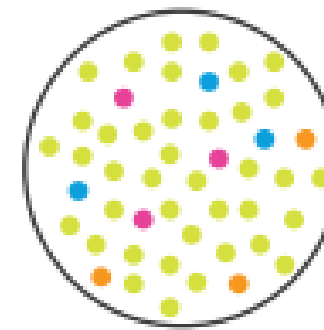
exclusion



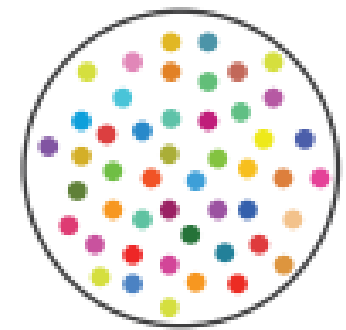
segregation



integration



inclusion



teaching to
diversity





The Ministry of Education, ***Special Education Services: A Manual of Policies, Procedures and Guidelines*** describes a modified program as:

“Instructional and assessment-related decisions are made to address a student’s educational needs that consist of individualized learning goals as opposed to provincial learning outcomes”.



Modified Educational Programs

- Modified programming is for students whose special needs are such that they are **unable to access the learning outcomes** of the curriculum. For example;
 - Students with **limited awareness** of their surroundings;
 - Students with **fragile mental/physical health**;
 - Students who are **medically and cognitively challenged**.
- A student's educational program cannot be modified without consultation with parents or guardians.

Modified Educational Programs

Special Education Services: A Manual of Policies, Procedures and Guidelines.

- Students on modified programs are **assessed in relation to** the goals and objectives established in their **Individual Education Plan (IEP)**.
- Students on a modified program receive an ***Evergreen Certificate*** upon school completion.
- Some students spend an extra year in public school to complete the goals in their IEP.

Modified Educational Programs

Transition Planning for Adulthood: Role of the School

- Students with certain developmental disabilities often qualify for community support services once they transition into adulthood.
- Beginning in Gr. 10, the student's case manager and family begin coordinating with these community services to plan for the student's transition out of the public school system.
- Updated cognitive/adaptive assessment *may* happen around Gr. 10.
 - EAs could be asked to complete rating scales as part of the assessment



Transition Planning: Community Services

- **Community Living British Columbia (CLBC)**
 - Can apply for eligibility when a student turns 16 years old
 - STADD Navigator services
- **Development Disabilities Association**
- **Persons with Disabilities (PWD)** funding application: apply at 17.5 yrs
- **StudentAid BC**
 - Appendix 8: Request for Permanent Disability form



Adapted and Modified Education Programs

ACTIVITY in Canvas:

Handout: Is this an adapted or modified program?

- Complete this handout individually.
- Large group sharing of answers.

Designation versus Diagnosis: Review

- **Designation:** a way to *identify* students and provide support services based on the category they qualify under.
- **Diagnosis:** a formal medical or psychological term given to a student after a evaluation or assessment from a qualified medical or psychological professional.
- **Example:** Gr. 5 student with an H designation (Intensive Behaviour/Serious Mental Illness).
 - Student was diagnosed by a psychiatrist with an **Anxiety Disorder** using the Diagnostic and Statistical Manual of Mental Disorders (5th Edition).
 - Student is seen by the psychiatrist weekly for therapy.

Low Incidence	Level 1: \$38,140 \$49,070	A	Physically Dependent – Multiple Needs
		B	Deaf-Blind
	Level 2: \$19,070 \$23,280	C	Moderate to Profound Intellectual Disabilities
		D	Physical Disability or Chronic Health Impairment
		E	Visual Impairment
		F	Deaf or Hard of Hearing
		G	Autism Spectrum Disorder (ASD)
	Level 3: \$9,610 \$11,760	H	Students Requiring Intensive Behaviour Intervention or Students with Serious Mental Illness
High Incidence	No supplemental funding; basic per-student allocation only	K	Mild Intellectual Disabilities
		P	Gifted
		Q	Learning Disabilities
		R	Students Requiring Behaviour Support or Students with Mental Illness

Low Incidence Categories

Categories A through H are called “Low Incidence” categories.

because there is a **relatively low incidence of students** in these categories, compared to the general school population.



Category A: Physically Dependent

Overview:

- A student with dependent needs is completely **dependent on others** for meeting all major daily living needs. She/he will require assistance at all times for feeding, dressing, toileting, mobility and personal hygiene.
- Without such assistance and personal care support, attendance at school would not be possible.
- The **estimated prevalence** in British Columbia of school-age students requiring this very intense level of service is **.07%** of the student population.



Overview:

- Some students are **born with conditions** or disabilities that make them dependent, while others **acquire conditions** or disabilities. For some students, **increasing independence** as they learn and grow is a reasonable expectation.
- For other students, **decreasing independence** may occur due to degenerative conditions or terminal illness.

Special Education Services: A Manual of Policies, Procedures and Guidelines.



Physically Dependent



Physically Dependent

Support Considerations:

- In providing services to a student with dependent needs, unique issues around **seating, lifting, positioning, movement, feeding, medication, hygiene** and **safety** will have to be addressed by the school-based team.
- Many of these can be carried out in a classroom environment, but others, for reasons of privacy and dignity, require a more secluded space.

Special Education Services: A Manual of Policies, Procedures and Guidelines



Support Considerations

- The student will also require **adaptations** to the **learning environment** to participate in aspects of school life and to maximize independence. The student should have access to as many parts of the school as possible, to increase opportunities for participation.
- **Equipment accessibility** in these areas will also have to be addressed. **Adaptations to facilities** or equipment to allow access to school areas and programs should be made as quickly as possible where physical barriers exist.

Special Education Services: A Manual of Policies, Procedures and Guidelines.



Physically Dependent





Physically Dependent

Support Considerations:

- Recent and ongoing **technological advances** in adaptive devices related to computer access, environmental controls and augmented communication have greatly enhanced learning opportunities for students with dependent needs.
- SET BC (**Special Education Technology BC**) is an extremely useful provincial program to support school based teams.

www.Setbc.org



A Conversation with Chase

ACTIVITY:

- With partners, discuss this video.
- Large group sharing: <https://www.setbc.org/resources/conversations-with-chase/>



Physically Dependent

Educational Programming:

- Some students with dependent needs are of **average or above average** intellectual ability and can **meet the learning outcomes** identified in the regular curriculum if **appropriate adaptations** are made to instruction and assessment methods.
- Some students may require **extensive modifications** to parts or their entire program so that the learning outcomes will be substantially different from the regular curriculum. In these cases, evaluation will be based on the degree to which the **goals and objectives in the IEP** are achieved. Evaluation would be referenced to individually set standards.

Special Education Services: A Manual of Policies, Procedures and Guidelines.





Category B: Deafblind

Overview:

- A student with deaf/blindness has a degree of **visual and auditory impairment** which, when compounded, results in **significant difficulties** in developing communicative, educational, vocational and social skills.
- To be considered deafblind, the student's vision and auditory impairments can range from partial sight to total blindness and from moderate to profound hearing loss.

Special Education Services: A Manual of Policies, Procedures and Guidelines





Overview:

- Deafblindness is considered an **information-gathering disability**.
- **Congenital Deafblindness:** Congenital deafblindness refers to individuals who are **born with** both visual and hearing losses and/or who experience these dual sensory losses early in life.
- **Acquired Deafblindness: Acquired** deafblindness refers to individuals who experience a combined vision and hearing loss later in life, usually after the development of language. The vision and hearing losses may be simultaneous or may occur at separate times. The losses may be acute and/or progressive.



Deafblind



Deafblind

Deafblind students:

- Experience of the world is determined by their **physical contact** with objects and people in the environment;
- Have **limited access to information** and will face challenges in developing mobility, communication, social interaction and with learning;
- Experience **difficulty** with **anticipation, motivation, communication** and **feedback** from the environment;
- Incidental learning opportunities are greatly limited and **conceptual development** and **experiential learning differ significantly** from that of other children.

Manitoba Education and Advanced Learning Program and Student Services Branch



Deafblind

Support Considerations:

- Mobility must be encouraged within a more accessible environment and specific skills including **spatial** and **object permanence** (taught by an Orientation and Mobility specialist);
- May be unable to detect enough information to understand what is going on around them and to experience control over the environment. This can lead to **confusion** and **frustration**, which may manifest as aggression, stress, withdrawal or self-stimulation.

Manitoba Education and Advanced Learning Program and
Student Services Branch





Deafblind

Support Considerations:

- Patience, respect, and a **willingness to find a way to communicate** are your best tools.
- **Presume competence.**
- When you approach a person with deaf-blindness, **identify yourself** and **speak directly to them**.
- **Ask permission** before touching the individual, unless it is an emergency.
- **Speak directly** to the **person**, not to the intervenor.

Ontario's Universities: Accessible Campus



Deafblind

When an IEP is developed, the following needs should be considered:

- communication skills;
- social skills;
- orientation and mobility skills;
- visual skills;
- auditory skills;
- daily living skills;
- academic skills;
- specialized skills in reading (e.g., braille, large print, closed captioned TV [CCTV]);
- specialized skills in mathematics (e.g., abacus, Nemeth Code);
- access to technology (e.g., tape recorders, microcomputers); and
- study skills and note-taking strategies.



DO it with ME

Suzanne Piquette- Lachapelle

Do it with me and not for me

Encourage me- **I can learn**

Able to make choices for myself.

Feeling surrounds my well being- **You are my eyes, ears and, at times, my voice**

Believe that I can learn- **Work hand in hand with me**

Listen to me and observe my body language- **I need to communicate! I can learn to communicate!**

Imagine who I can become- **I have a future**

Notice me! **I want to live life to the fullest**

Do it with me and not for me—I can teach you the person that I am—How I learn. What I like, dislike and what I need.

Ontario College of Teachers: Additional Qualification Course Guideline
Teaching Students who are Deafblind





Deafblind

The Provincial Outreach Program for Deafblind Students is available to provide consultative services to school districts enrolling deafblind students. The consultants are educational specialists in the field of deafblindness.

Consultants work with the team of service providers to help them **plan and implement** a consistent program designed to meet the needs of the deafblind student in the school, the family and the community.

<http://popdb.sd38.bc.ca/>

ACTIVITY:

- Individually, take a few moments to look at this website.
 - Large group share.
- 

Deafblind

Educational Programming:

- The **needs of deafblind students** are **varied**.
- Some students who are deafblind will **not be able** to access the curriculum and will be on a **modified program** with their progress being reported on their attainment of goals and objectives in the IEP.
- Some students who are deafblind **will be able** to meet the learning outcomes of the curriculum if appropriate adaptations are made to instruction and assessment methods. In these cases, students will be considered on an **adapted program**.

Category C: Moderate to Profound Intellectual Disability

Overview:

- Students with intellectual disabilities have general **intellectual functioning** significantly **below the mean**, as well as significant **limitations** in **adaptive functioning** in at least two of the following skill areas as appropriate to the student's age:
 - communication,
 - self-care,
 - home living,
 - social/interpersonal skills,
 - use of community resources,
 - self-direction,
 - functional academic skills,
 - work, leisure,
 - health and safety.

Moderate to Profound Intellectual Disability

Overview:

- Students can experience intellectual disabilities across a range: **mild to profound**.
- A diagnosis of intellectual disability should only be made when a student has **significant limitations** in both **intellectual** and **adaptive** functioning.

Special Education Services: A Manual of Policies, Procedures and Guidelines

Moderate to Profound Intellectual Disability

Overview:

- Students with moderate to profound intellectual disabilities have particular learning characteristics.
- They require support in the development of **academic** skills, **communication** skills, **cognitive** skills, **fine** and **gross motor** skills, **self-care**, **life skills** and **socialization skills**.
- Generally, a student with this level of intellectual functioning is also significantly **delayed** in **social-emotional** development.
- There may also be accompanying **sensory**, **physical** and **health** disabilities.



https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ur2KH_YSyJQ

Intellectual Disability Awareness

ACTIVITY:

- In your groups, discuss what resonated with you in this video?
- Large group sharing.



Moderate to Profound Intellectual Disability



Support Considerations:

- **Minimize frustration** by offering academics at an instructional level and ensuring clear instructions;
 - Observe, honour and **respond to non-verbal communication**;
 - Support **self-regulation** challenges in a developmentally appropriate way;
 - Use **visual supports** for transitions;
 - Use **concrete** learning materials;
 - Instruction in **shorter blocks** with additional scaffolding.
 - Support **social connection** by developing shared interests with peers.
- 

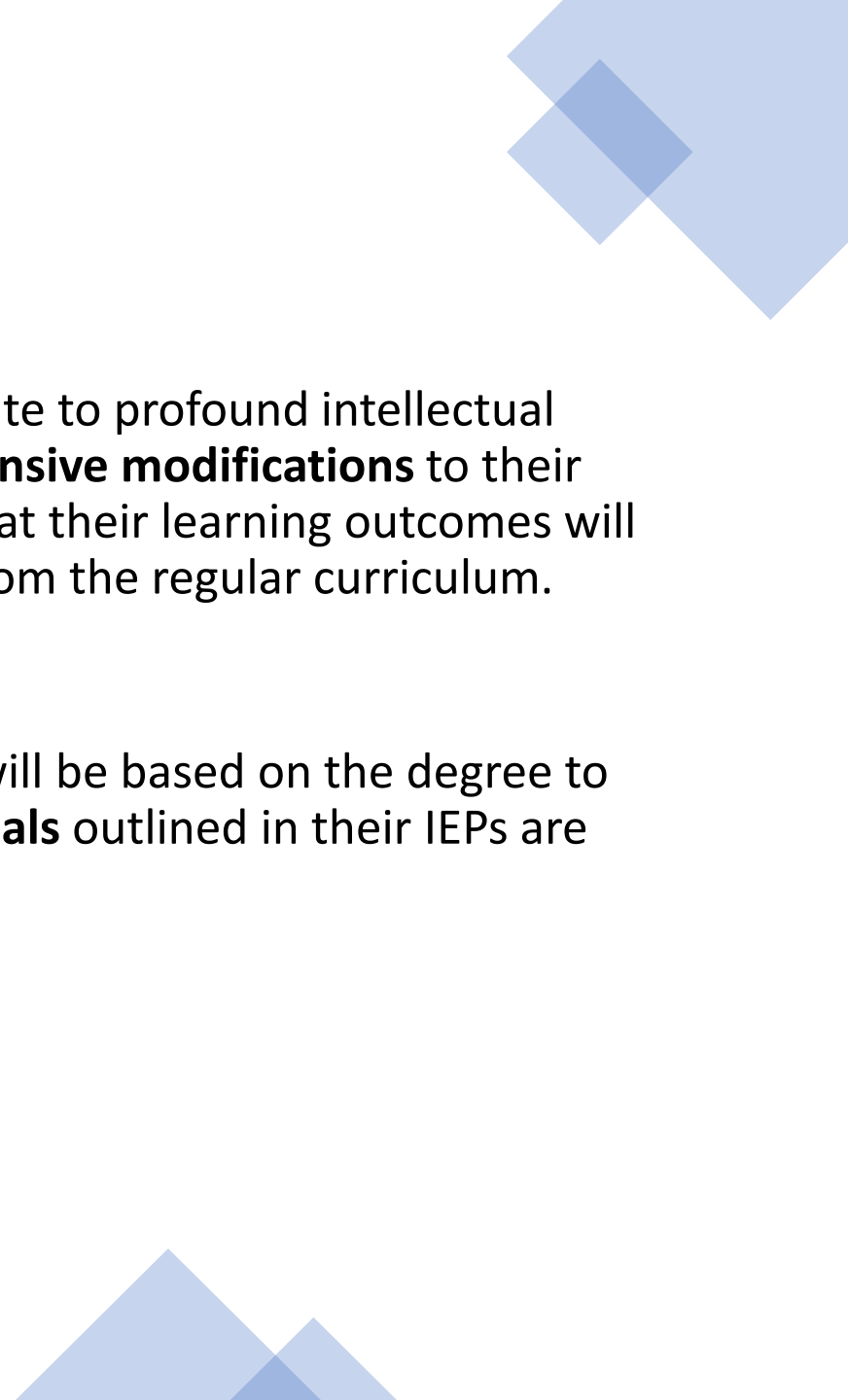


Moderate to Profound Intellectual Disability



Moderate to Profound Intellectual Disability

Educational Programming:

- Most students with moderate to profound intellectual disabilities will require **extensive modifications** to their educational programs so that their learning outcomes will be substantially different from the regular curriculum.
 - In these cases, evaluation will be based on the degree to which the **individualized goals** outlined in their IEPs are achieved.
- 



Category D: Physical Disability or Chronic Health Impairment

Overview:

- A student is considered to have a physical disability or chronic health impairment based on the **need for special educational services** due to one or more of the following:
 - **nervous system** impairment that impacts movement or mobility;
 - **musculoskeletal** condition; and/or
 - **chronic health** impairment that seriously impacts the student's education and achievement.

Special Education Services: A Manual of Policies, Procedures and Guidelines



Physical Disability or Chronic Health Impairment

Overview:

- A **medical diagnosis**, by itself, **does not** determine the need for special educational services by students with physical disabilities or chronic health impairments.
- Students are only eligible for funding in this category if their functioning and education is **significantly affected** by their physical disabilities or chronic health impairments.

Special Education Services: A Manual of Policies, Procedures and Guidelines

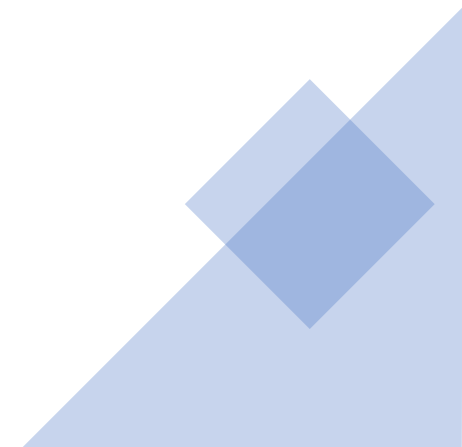


Physical Disability or Chronic Health Impairment

“Invisible” physical disabilities; e.g.

- Diabetes
- Epilepsy
- Brain injury

“Visible” physical disabilities; e.g.

- Cerebral Palsy
 - Spina Bifida
 - Birth Defects
- 



Overview:

- A student with a physical disability/chronic health impairment needs **support managing health considerations** and/or **overcoming environmental barriers** to accessing education.
- Students with physical disabilities or chronic health impairments should have **opportunities to participate in school activities** to the greatest extent possible.
- **Adaptations to facilities or equipment** to allow access to school areas and programs should be made where physical barriers exist.
- For some students, **increasing dependence** is expected due to degenerative conditions or terminal illnesses.



Physical Disability or Chronic Health Impairment

Physical Disability or Chronic Health Impairment

Overview:

- In some cases, students diagnosed through the **Complex Developmental Behavioural Conditions (CDBC)** Network as children and youth with complex needs may be included in this category.
- Regionally, the CDBC Network has been established to assess children and youth with complex needs, including children and youth who may have **fetal alcohol spectrum disorder (FASD)**.

Special Education Services: A Manual of Policies, Procedures and Guidelines



Alcohol Effects on Developing Brain

POPFASD

ACTIVITY:

- With a partner, discuss what resonated with you in this video.
- Large group sharing.



Physical Disability or Chronic Health Impairment





Provincial Outreach Program for Fetal Alcohol Spectrum Disorders (POPFASD)

- A collection of POPFASD-developed resources in addition to curated resources from around the web. Training is also offered.

<https://www.fasdoutreach.ca/>

ACTIVITY:

- Individually, take a few moments to look at this website.
- With your group, share what you've found on the website.
- Large group share.



Physical Disability or Chronic Health Impairment





Physical Disability or Chronic Health Impairment

Support Considerations:

- Promote **peer understanding** of the physical disability;
- Teach peers to **presume competence**;
- May require **additional time** to complete academic tasks independently;
- Allow **alternate methods** of showing understanding if writing challenges are present.
- Use **preferential seating** and extra space due to equipment;
- May tire easily—allow **rest breaks**;
- May require physical **assistance** with **self care**;
- May need **support** with **communication**.

Physical Disability or Chronic Health Impairment

Educational Programming:

- In **most cases**, students with physical disabilities or chronic health impairments will take part in the **regular program** with the necessary **adaptations**. Evaluation will be based on the regular standards (i.e., extent to which the learning outcomes were achieved).
- Some students may require **extensive modifications** to parts of their program so that some of their learning outcomes will be substantially different from the regular curriculum. In these cases, evaluation will be based on the degree to which the **goals** and **objectives** of the **IEP** are **achieved**.
- Students may require **specialized intervention** for academic and social success as well as independence skills which may include OT/PT, SLP etc.



<https://www.setbc.org/setstories/>



SET BC Stories

ACTIVITY:

- Take a few minutes individually to read through some of the stories or view the videos on the SET BC website. We've already seen the video conversation with Chase, but there are many other stories.
 - What resonates with you when you read these stories?
 - Pick one story to share with the class.
- 



Open book quiz next class on **DAY 1**
content.